

Athanasios Papaioannou

Senior Research Scientist & Generative AI Engineer

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Education

PhD	Imperial College London , Computing	London, UK 2012 – 2016
MSc	Aristotle University of Thessaloniki , Informatics	Thessaloniki, Greece 2003 – 2005
BSc	Aristotle University of Thessaloniki , Informatics	Thessaloniki, Greece 1999 – 2003

Experience

Google , Research Software Engineer, Generative AI	London, UK Sept 2026 – present 2 months
Research and engineering on generative AI for 3D/4D vision applications.	
Huawei Research , Senior Research Engineer	London, UK June 2020 – Sept 2026 6 years 4 months
- Led computer vision research on neural rendering, 3D/4D reconstruction, and generative modelling of humans and scenes, including feed-forward Gaussian splatting for novel-view synthesis. - Designed and trained large-scale generative 3D models (statistical, mesh-based, and implicit morphable representations) for high-fidelity human modelling. - Built end-to-end data pipelines for multi-view, RGB-D, and 4D capture data, supporting model training, evaluation, and deployment on complex visual datasets. - Drove evaluation and ablation methodology for reconstruction quality, geometric accuracy, and view-consistency, enabling systematic model comparison and iteration. - Translated research prototypes into integration-ready systems in collaboration with infrastructure and engineering teams; supervised junior researchers and contributed to research direction setting. - Co-organised the View Synthesis Challenge for Human Heads at ICCVW 2023.	
Facesoft , Senior Research Engineer	London, UK Nov 2019 – June 2020 8 months
- Developed deep learning models for face analysis, recognition, and representation learning, deployed in real-time production computer vision systems. - Designed data processing and training pipelines for large-scale face datasets, with emphasis on robustness across demographics and capture conditions.	
Institute of Child Health, UCL , Research Associate	London, UK Jan 2018 – Oct 2019 1 year 10 months
- Developed statistical and deep learning methods for analysing complex 3D craniofacial datasets, including mesh autoencoders for clinical 3D shape analysis. - Built data processing and evaluation workflows for clinical 3D datasets and collaborated with surgeons, clinicians, and researchers on translational ML projects. - Contributed to peer-reviewed publications on 3D shape modelling and clinical decision support.	
Imperial College London , Research Associate	London, UK Jan 2017 – Dec 2018 2 years
Developed face tracking and verification systems for secure online assessment platforms, including identity verification and behavioural analysis components deployed at scale.	

Imperial College London, Research Assistant

- Built large-scale 4D facial datasets for emotion and behaviour recognition research; developed algorithms for automated facial analysis and statistical 3D modelling.
- Contributed to national and European research projects on face and behaviour analysis.

London, UK

Oct 2012 – Dec 2016

4 years 3 months

Interests

World Models

Vision-Language-Action (VLA) Systems

Agentic Perception

Dynamic Scene Understanding

Embodied AI

Skills

3D / 4D Vision

Generative & Representation Learning

ML Systems & Methodology

Programming

Frameworks & Tools

Publications

ICo3D: An Interactive Conversational 3D Virtual Human

Jan 2026

*joint first authorship

R. Shaw, Y. Jang, A. Papaioannou, A. Moreau, H. Dharmo, Z. Zhang, E. Perez-Pellitero
(IJCV, 134, 161)

imHead: A Large-Scale Implicit Morphable Model for Localized Head Modeling

Jan 2025

R. Potamias, S. Galanakis, J. Deng, A. Papaioannou, S. Zafeiriou
(ICCV)

MimicME: A Large Scale Diverse 4D Database for Facial Expression Analysis

Jan 2022

A. Papaioannou, B. Gecer, S. Cheng
(ECCV)

Convolutional Mesh Autoencoders for the 3-Dimensional Identification of FGFR-related Craniosynostosis

Jan 2022

E. O'Sullivan, L. S. van de Lande, A. Papaioannou
(Scientific Reports, 12, 2230)

Synthesizing Coupled 3D Face Modalities by Trunk-Branch Generative Adversarial Networks

Jan 2020

B. Gecer, A. Lattas, S. Ploumpis, J. Deng, A. Papaioannou, S. Moschoglou, S. Zafeiriou
(ECCV)

Service

ICCVW 2023, Challenge Organiser — View Synthesis Challenge for Human Heads

BMVC 2017, Local Chair & Web Chair

